

Menier Chocolate Factory

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Coordinates: 51°50′51″N 0°09′72″W﻿ / ﻿

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The **Menier Chocolate Factory** is a 180-seat off-West End theatre, which comprises a bar and theatre offices.

It is located at the rear of a former 1870s *Menier Chocolate Company* factory at 53 *Southwark Street*, a major street in the *London Borough of Southwark*, central south London, England, some 2.5 km from the theatrical West End. The theatre stages plays and *musicals*, live music and stand-up comedy. According to the *Evening Standard*, it is "one of the most dynamic fringe venues in London".^[]

History and awards

edit

The French company *Menier Chocolate* Company expanded overseas and built a five-storey factory and warehouse of brick with stone dressings in London between 1865 and 1874. It was listed *Grade II* in 1996.^[]

The Menier Chocolate Factory was opened in 2004 in its current incarnation, it is within a purpose built space at the rear of the factory, connecting through the adjoining buildings. It is run by artistic director David Babani.^[] In 2005, the theatre received the Peter Brook/Empty Space Up and Coming Venue Award. In the same year, he and co-founder Danielle Tarento jointly won the *Evening Standard* Milton Shulman Award for Outstanding Newcomer. Tarento left in 2006 to pursue a solo producing career, and was replaced by General Manager Thomas Siracusa.^[citation needed]

In 2007 the Chocolate Factory production of the *Stephen Sondheim* musical *Sunday in the Park with George* won five *Olivier Awards*, including Best Actor in a Musical for *Daniel Evans* and Best Actress in a Musical for *Jenna Russell*. The pair went on to perform the lead roles when the production transferred to Studio 54 on Broadway in February 2008.^[citation needed]

In the 2009 Olivier Awards, *Douglas Hodge* won the trophy for Best Actor in a Musical for his portrayal of Albin in *La Cage aux Folles*. The production also won the Best Musical Revival category.^[citation needed]

In 2010, the Chocolate Factory productions of *A Little Night Music* and *La Cage aux Folles* opened on Broadway. The former starring *Catherine Zeta Jones* and *Annela Lansbury* and the latter starring

Menier Chocolate Factory

Exterior of the theatre

London

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Wikimedia

OpenStreetMap

Address

53 Southwark Street
London, SE1
England, United Kingdom

Coordinates

51°50′51″N 0°09′72″W﻿ / ﻿

Public transit

London Bridge

Type

Fringe theatre

Capacity

180

Opened

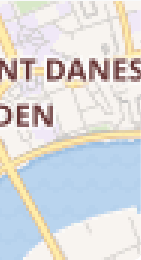
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Scottish Information Commissioner

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The **Scottish Information Commissioner** (*Scottish Gaelic*: *Coimiseanair Fiosrachaidh na h-Alba*) is responsible for the promotion and enforcement of the *Freedom of Information (Scotland) Act 2002* (FOISA) and the *Environmental Information (Scotland) Regulations 2004*^[](Scottish EIRs). The current Scottish Information Commissioner is David Hamilton who took up post on 16 October 2023.

Background

edit

This legislation generates thousands of requests to Scotland's public authorities for information. Often these involve high profile, controversial or sensitive matters, which have to be resolved when appealed to the Commissioner. The Commissioner employs 21 staff in *St Andrews*, *Fife*, *Scotland*, to help him investigate and decide upon cases, provide information to the public on their rights, and assess whether Scottish public authorities are following good practice.^[]

FOISA came into full force on 1 January 2005, at the same time as the Scottish EIRs. In July 2010, the 1,000th decision was issued by the Scottish Information Commissioner.^[] The Commissioner publishes information on the number of cases he has on hand on his website.^[] The Commissioner issues guidance for public authorities on their obligations under FOISA,^[] and publishes information on rights to information for the public.^[]

The Commissioner is appointed by *The King* on the nomination of the *Scottish Parliament*, and is an independent public official who makes legally enforceable decisions. They can be enforced by the *Court of Session* and public authorities may be held in *contempt of court* if an authority fails to comply with a decision notice.^[]

Holders of the Post

edit

The first Commissioner was *Kevin Dunion*, appointed in February 2003. Towards the end of his second term he proposed extra powers that he thought that the next Commissioner would need.^[] He left office on 23 February 2012 after two terms - a total of nine years in office, during which time he handled some 1,500 cases.^[] It was announced on 3 February 2017, that *Rosemary Agnew*, the previous Scottish Information Commissioner, would be stepping down on 30 April 2017 and taking up a post as the Scottish Public Services Ombudsman on 1 May 2017.^[] In June 2017, Fitzhenry was nominated for the role, having previously worked in the *Royal Air Force*'s legal branch.^[] Former *Police Scotland* Inspector David Hamilton is the current Scottish Information Commissioner having been nominated by the Scottish Parliament on 28 June 2023.^[]

Name	Took up post	Status
David Hamilton	16 October 2023	Incumbent
Daren Fitzhenry	25 October 2017	15 October 2023
Margaret Keyse†	1 May 2017	22 October 2017
Rosemary Agnew	1 May 2012	30 April 2017
Margaret Keyse†	24 February 2012	30 April 2012

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